



Hitachi CP-Rs55

and the grille effect surrounding the body reveal a total lack of aesthetic sense.

The oddly-shaped Epson comes across as trying too hard, with its overactive shapes and contours. The Acer PD-115 is pretty average in the looks department, with nothing substantial to write home about—but tolerable nonetheless.

The build quality of the Sharp and the Hitachi was excellent, which can be felt with the smooth and progressive nature of their focus rings. The quality levels were excellent, with a great tactile feel to the buttons. The BenQ MP-610 had the worst build and finish levels of the lot, with a cheap feel to the plastic and an absolutely dreadful jerking feel to its focus ring. This one really feels built to its price.

The Hitachi CP-RS55 was the lightest of the bunch at 2.2 kg, as opposed to the Sharp XR-10S weighing in at a massive 3.9 kg. This completely defies the notion that LCDs are bulkier when compared to DLPs.

The lack of any optical zoom on the Hitachi can be attributed to its weight-saving measures. It only has digital zoom, which must be avoided at all costs.

The Epson EMP-S3 has the highest optical zoom ratio of 1.35:1. All the projectors had the essential set of features—projection modes, keystone correction, preset modes, etc. The Sharp led the pack as far as OSD usability and features were concerned. We were impressed by the wizard-like interface it used for troubleshooting, which rectifies the display according to the symptoms you specify. This will enable even a complete layman to tweak his projector to perfection.

The Sharp had the most comprehensive, albeit dull-looking remote, which could have done with better button segregation.

The Acer PD-115 had the best remote of the lot, with colour-coded keys separated intuitively by button shapes and position. The remote can be easily handled in the dark.

The Epson EMP-S3 had the second-best remote, with great button placement—it also offered a thumb-stick for mouse control! The Hitachi's remote was brilliant, but was let down by poor button quality. The BenQ shipped with the least impressive card-type remote, which suffered from a severe lack of buttons. The buttons required a hard push to get registered.

## XGA

The three XGA projectors we received for testing had better build and finish quality, but were lacking on features. Not surprisingly, due to our (approximately) Rs 1 lakh price limit for this test, we could only get the entry-level XGA projectors. Their brightness ratings and other features were thus on par with their SVGA counterparts.

The Sharp XR-10X had the upper hand with an image size of 300 inches, with the Infocus LP-600 and HP MP-2225 coming in second and third respectively, with 268 and 230 inches of maximum projection size.

The brightness of the projectors was on par with the SVGA models, the only exception being the HP at 1400 lumens. The XGA models came with the 4:3 aspect ratio, along with the capability to display in the 16:9 mode. The HP MP-2225 had the best contrast ratio of 2200:1; the 2000:1 ratio of the Sharp XR-10X was similar to that of its cheaper sibling. The Infocus LP-600 had the poorest contrast ratio of 1000:1—surprising, since DLPs are supposed to do better than that.

The diminutive HP was the lightest, weighing in at just 1.1 kg. It was the smallest of the lot with a dual-tone design reminiscent of the Sharp. If portability is the criterion, look no further; they don't get any smaller than the HP projector.

The Sharp XR-10X had the exact same shape, size and build as its SVGA counterpart; the only differentiating factor was the champagne-gold finish this one sported.

But our favourite design amongst these was definitely the Infocus LP-600. Its LCD display panel, aesthetically proportioned contours and button layout all exuded a look that does justice to its price. All these sported excellent levels of build quality, with the Sharp once again beating the competition to it. But it lost out to the lightweight HP and Infocus, which weighed in at 1.1 kg and 2.4 kg respectively. The Infocus, however, clawed back with a class-leading zoom ratio of 1.24:1, with the Sharp and HP following, tied at 1.15:1.

In miscellaneous features, such as projection modes, keystone correction, and preset modes, these projectors didn't disappoint us. The Sharp OSD was unbeatable in this segment too.

The HP MP-2225 disappointed us with its card-like remote, which doesn't bode well for an XGA projector. However, it does offer mouse control, and its keys aren't too bad. The Sharp remote is similar to its SVGA counterpart, which is a shame,



Acer PD115